03-22 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） The 24 Solar Terms: An Ancient Chinese Calendar

① If you live in China, you may have heard names like **"Start of Spring" (Lichun)**, **"Grain Rain" (Guyu)**, or **"Great Cold" (Dahan)**. These are part of the **24 Solar Terms**, an old Chinese system that divides a whole year into 24 small seasons. It was built by farmers and scholars more than **2,000 years ago**, and in 2016 it was listed as a World Cultural Heritage by UNESCO.

② How does the system work? Our ancestors watched the **sun's path in the sky**. They noticed that the sun's position slowly changes through the year, and they cut this long journey into 24 equal parts — one term every **about 15 days**. Each term has its own short poem-like name, such as **"Waking of Insects"** (around 5 March), **"Grain Full"** (around 21 May), and **"White Dew"** (around 7 September). The names are not random. They capture a small change — a bud, a rain, a frost, or a certain song of birds — that people could clearly see on the land.

③ The 24 terms were first created for **farming**. Before modern weather forecasts, a farmer in the Yellow River area had to decide: is today a good day to plough the field? Should I plant wheat or millet? The terms acted like a wise old friend. "Qingming" told him the soil was warm enough for sowing; "Mangzhong" told him it was time to harvest wheat; "Frost's Descent" reminded him to bring in the last pumpkins. Even today, on countless village walls, you can still find **old almanacs** full of rules like "three rains after Guyu".

④ But the 24 terms are **more than a calendar**. They also shape how Chinese people eat and live. At **"Winter Solstice" (Dongzhi)**, many northern families eat dumplings to keep ears warm in the cold wind. Around **"Start of Spring"**, some southern cities still prepare spring rolls with fresh vegetables. Doctors of traditional Chinese medicine use the terms to advise people to sleep earlier in autumn and to walk more in spring. Poets of the Tang and Song dynasties wrote hundreds of short poems about these terms, turning simple sky changes into lines of gentle beauty.

⑤ Some young people today ask, "Do we still need the 24 terms in the age of phones and GPS?" Perhaps modern farmers no longer rely only on them. Yet when a 13-year-old student stops to notice the first swallow in March, or helps grandma plant leeks after "Qingming", a little bridge is built between today and our long past. The 24 Solar Terms quietly remind us that **people, plants, and weather breathe the same year** — and that tradition, when kept alive by small actions, can never truly grow old.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the article mainly about?

A. How the Chinese people started farming more than 2,000 years ago.
B. The 24 Solar Terms and their roles in Chinese life and farming.
C. Why UNESCO chose many Chinese traditions as World Heritage.
D. How modern technology has replaced every old farming idea.

2. How did ancient Chinese people create the 24 Solar Terms?

A. By counting the days between two floods of the Yellow River.
B. By watching the sun's changing position in the sky through the year.
C. By collecting letters from famous poets.
D. By measuring the height of different crops.

3. Which of the following was a use of the solar terms in farming?

A. Telling farmers when it was warm enough to sow seeds.
B. Telling farmers how to set the price of wheat.
C. Warning farmers to pay the yearly tax.
D. Teaching farmers how to use tractors.

4. According to paragraph ④, the 24 terms also influence _____.

A. only the names of old poems
B. daily food, habits, and traditional medicine
C. only modern school timetables
D. only the sales of wheat and rice

5. What is the writer's main attitude in the last paragraph?

A. The 24 Solar Terms are useless in modern cities.
B. Tradition can stay young through small everyday actions.
C. Young people must return to farming in villages.
D. Modern phones will soon replace all old Chinese ideas.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文围绕 24 节气的形成、功能与文化影响
【解析】文章主述 24 节气及其多方面作用。A、C、D 非整体主旨。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "watched the sun's path... cut this long journey into 24 equal parts"
【解析】通过观察太阳位置划分节气。A、C、D 无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "'Qingming' told him the soil was warm enough for sowing"
【解析】节气告知何时播种。B、C、D 未提及。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节归纳题
【定位】第④段食物、中医、诗歌多方面描写
【解析】影响饮食、习俗与中医养生。A、C、D 过于片面或错误。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】观点态度题
【定位】第⑤段 "tradition, when kept alive by small actions, can never truly grow old"
【解析】主张以小行动延续传统。A、C、D 与作者态度相反。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **solar** [adj.] 太阳的
- **almanac** [n.] 农历；黄历
- **sow** [v.] 播种